

{PROXY}Maze'26

Challenge 2 — Video Submission Criteria

Stage 3 requirement for all 10 shortlisted teams.

Torch Labs Software | Submission deadline: June 21, 2026

Overview

Each shortlisted team must submit an elevator pitch video explaining their product idea, the problem they are solving, the market opportunity, and their current progress.

These videos will be published on the official Torch Labs and {PROXY}Maze'26 social media channels. They are also used to determine the Most Popular Project Award, which is given out on Grand Final day, July 12.

Submitting a video is mandatory for all top 10 teams. Teams that do not submit by June 21 are removed from the competition.

1. Video Length

The video must be under 2 minutes. Use the structure below to manage your time. You do not have to follow it exactly, but every section listed should appear somewhere in the video.

Section	What to cover	Time
Hook / opening	Grab attention. Say who you are and what you are solving.	5–10 sec
Team and story	Briefly introduce the team and how you found this problem.	10–15 sec
Idea in 2 sentences	State the product and the value it provides, clearly.	10–15 sec
Problem and pain point	Name the target user, the pain, and the cost if unsolved.	20–25 sec
Market size and market value	Show that the problem is real and that people would pay.	15–20 sec
Solution and product explanation	Demo or show what you built and what the user can do.	25–30 sec
Torch Labs proxy usage	Say which proxy product you use and why it is central.	10–15 sec

Section	What to cover	Time
Current progress	Show what is working. Be honest about what is still in progress.	15–20 sec
Closing	One clear statement about where this product goes next.	5–10 sec

2. Branding and Frame Requirements

Torch Labs will add a branded frame or overlay to every submitted video before publishing. The frame includes the Torch Labs and {PROXY}Maze'26 logos.

Teams must leave enough safe space around the edges of the video so that the frame does not cover important content.

- Do not place key information, faces, or product screens in the corners of the frame.
- Do not place critical content very close to the top or bottom edges.
- Keep the main action and text in the central two-thirds of the frame.

3. Idea Summary

Every team must explain their product idea in 2 clear sentences somewhere in the video. These two sentences should be written before filming begins, not improvised on camera.

The two sentences should answer three questions: what is the product, who is it for, and what value does it provide.

Suggested structure: Our product helps [target users] solve [specific problem] by using [solution]. It creates value by [main benefit], using Torch Labs residential or ISP proxies to [proxy-related function].

4. Problem and Pain Point

Teams must clearly explain the problem they are solving. The problem section should cover four things:

- The target user or customer, named specifically by role or industry.
- The pain point they currently face and what it costs them in time or money.
- Why the problem matters and how it connects to one of the four hackathon tracks.
- What happens if the problem is not solved.

Vague problem statements score low in proposal judging and are equally unconvincing in video form. A named customer, a real cost, and a clear consequence are what make the problem feel real.

5. Market Size and Market Value

Teams must explain the potential market opportunity behind their product. This does not need to be a full business report, but teams should show that the idea has real-world commercial value.

Cover at least the following:

- Who would pay for this product and why.
- How large or important the target market is.
- Why this product could become commercially useful beyond the hackathon.
- A possible business model, pricing approach, or revenue opportunity.

Avoid making unsupported claims such as 'this is a billion-dollar idea' unless you can briefly justify it with logic, examples, or market references. Judges notice the difference.

6. Present a Product, Not Just Software

The video must present the idea as a product with potential market value, not just another software application or technical exercise.

Teams should be able to answer all four of the following in the video:

- What does the product do?
- Who would use it?
- Why would users choose it over what they use today?
- How could it be sold, adopted, or scaled?

If the video cannot answer these questions, it reads as a project, not a product. Judges are evaluating commercial potential alongside technical depth.

7. Use of Torch Labs Proxies

Teams must explain how they are using Torch Labs residential or ISP proxies in their product. The proxy section should clearly answer:

- Why does this product need proxies?
- Which Torch Labs proxy product is being used: residential, ISP, or both?
- How do proxies improve or enable the product?
- What proxy-related capability is central to the solution?

Examples of valid proxy-dependent use cases:

- Geo-localised access to regionally restricted data
- Market research and price intelligence at scale
- Data collection from sites that block datacenter IPs
- Availability monitoring across multiple locations
- Regional content testing and ad verification
- Anti-bot bypass for sustained automated workflows

Proxies must be load-bearing in your product. If you remove the proxy layer, the product should stop working. If proxies are only a speed improvement or a minor enhancement, that is decorative usage and it costs points.

8. Team Story

Teams must briefly explain their story. The story does not need to be long. It should feel authentic and help the audience connect with the team.

This can include any of the following:

- Who the team members are and what they do.
 - How they discovered the problem they are solving.
 - Why they chose this idea over others.
 - What inspired the product or what makes the team interested in this space.
-

9. Current Progress

Teams must show what they have already completed by the time of the video submission. This is not optional. Judges and voters want to see real progress, not just an idea.

Evidence of progress can include:

- A working prototype or MVP
- Working features with a screen recording or demo clip
- Technical architecture that has been built and tested
- Proxy integration that is running against a real target
- User research or customer discovery findings
- Next steps and what will be completed before July 12

If the product is not fully working yet, be honest. Show what is complete, what is in progress, and what is planned. Judges respect transparency over overselling.

10. Demo or Visual Proof

The video must include at least one form of visual proof of progress. A talking-head video with no visual content will not hold attention and will score lower.

Acceptable forms of visual proof include:

- A screen recording of the product in use
 - A live feature demo filmed on screen
 - A Figma mockup or prototype walkthrough
 - A dashboard or data output preview
-

- A technical flow diagram

If your product makes real proxy requests against a live target, show it running on screen. The UI can be rough. What matters is that the core pipeline works end to end.

11. Clarity and Presentation Quality

The video should be easy to understand for both technical and non-technical viewers. The judges panel includes people who are not engineers.

Focus on:

- A clear voiceover or readable captions throughout.
- Text on screen that is legible at 1080p.
- Good pacing — no dead air, no rushed slides.
- Simple explanation of technical concepts.
- Clean visuals with no clutter.
- No unnecessary jargon or overly long introductions.

12. Video Format

Specification	Requirement
Aspect ratio	16:9 horizontal
Resolution	Minimum 1080p
File format	MP4
Audio	Clear voiceover or readable captions required
Language	English, Sinhala, or Tamil. Include English captions if using Sinhala or Tamil.

13. Content Restrictions

The video must not include any of the following:

- False claims about the product, users, or market.
- Offensive, discriminatory, or inappropriate content.
- Copyrighted music or visuals used without permission.
- Confidential API keys, credentials, or private data shown on screen.
- Misleading product demonstrations that show features that do not exist.
- Fake user numbers, fake traction, or unsupported market claims presented as facts.

Torch Labs reserves the right to remove any video from publication if it violates these restrictions.

14. Final Checklist Before Submission

Before submitting, confirm your video covers all of the following:

- Is the video under 2 minutes?
- Did we explain the idea in 2 clear sentences?
- Did we name the target user and explain the problem and pain point clearly?
- Did we explain the market size or market value?
- Did we present this as a product with commercial potential, not just software?
- Did we explain how Torch Labs proxies are used and why they are essential?
- Did we share our team story?
- Did we show current progress with visual proof or a demo?
- Did we leave enough safe space around the edges for the branded frame?
- Is the voiceover clear or are captions readable throughout?
- Is the file 16:9, minimum 1080p, in MP4 format?

Questions

Contact the organising team for any questions about the video format, submission process, proxy usage, or judging criteria. A question asked before the deadline is better than a disqualification after it.